"Bleeding" Condition C in Kanien'kéha*

Chase Boles
McGill University

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1 Introduction

- The appearance of R-expressions has long been assumed to be governed by Condition C of Binding Theory, based on the notion of c-command (Chomsky 1981; Reinhart 1983).

(1) *Binding*
Nominal A binds another nominal B iff A c-commands B and A and B are covalued.

(2) *Condition C*
An R-expression must be free (i.e., unbound).

- Binding shows a large amount of stability cross-linguistically, suggesting universality (Reuland 2011; Grodzinsky and Reinhart 1993; Reinhart 1983).[1]

Problem: Work on a variety of languages has shown varied behavior with regards to Condition C.

- We can create a descriptive typology of clause-internal Condition C behavior:

		Non-violations	
		Accept	Reject
Violations	Reject	English	Warlpiri (Legate 2002), Basque (Marácz and Muysken 1989)
	Accept	Kanien'kéha (Baker 1996)	Chuj (Royer 2025)

- More intriguing: some languages appear to fill several cells (e.g., Malayalam, Mohanan 1983; Hungarian, Marácz and Muysken 1989; Choe 1989; Passamaquoddy, Bruening 2001).

- Notably, Condition C violations appear to be highly restricted, even in languages showing them (e.g., Legate 2002; Hoonchamlong 1991; Larson 2006), resulting in a concerted effort to derive the apparent variation in Condition C from language-internal quirks.

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[1] This also applies to coreference, when this is analyzed as separate from binding proper (Grodzinsky and Reinhart 1993).

➢ Some properties argued to result in the "variant" Condition C effects cross-linguistically: object shift (Legate 2002; Royer 2025), anticataphora (Mohanan 1983; Royer 2025), accidental coreference (Reinhart 1983; Bruening 2001), anaphoric islands (Legate 2002), complex indices (Chaiphet and Jenks 2021), ...

- Working with Kanien'kéha (Mohawk), Baker (1996) suggests another property that languages may have, allowing them to show unexpected Condition C effects: sentence-level adjunction of all overt nominals.
  - This property is a by-product of a deeper difference in the language faculty: Baker's Morphological Visibility Condition (MVC; the "Polysynthesis Parameter").
  - Baker specifically cites the Kanien'kéha Condition C data as evidence for high adjunction of overt nominals in languages obeying the MVC.

Proposal: Kanien'kéha exhibits Condition C effects across the board (as argued by Baker 1996). However, pace Baker, **structural ambiguity** is the culprit behind apparent Condition C violations in Kanien'kéha.

→ Condition C effects remain universal, without requiring certain languages to differ from each other in fundamental properties (i.e., without an appeal to macroparametric differences).

Roadmap:

Section 2: Background on Kanien'kéha.

Section 3: Condition C in Kanien'kéha and Baker's (1996) account.

Section 4: My main proposal and evidence from conjoined possessed objects.

Section 5: Diffusing some of Baker's arguments.

Section 6: Conclusion.

2 Kanien'kéha at a glance

- **Kanien'kéha** (Mohawk) is an Iroquoian language in the Five Nations group of the Northern branch, traditionally spoken in Upstate New York and Southern Québec (Mithun 2017).
  - Now spoken in six communities in Upstate New York, Southern Québec, and Southern Ontario.
- Severely endangered, EGIDS 8a (Moseley 2010; Lewis and Simons 2010). Speaker numbers vary; DeCaire (2023) estimates ~500 L1 speakers, mostly elders.
- Fast-growing L2 population due to successful adult and child immersion programs (DeCaire 2023; Stacey 2016).
- Often taken as a prototypical "polysynthetic" language.
  - ✧ Agglutinating with some degree of fusion in the pre-pronominal prefix domain (see Martin 2023 and Blackburn 2025).

- ✧ Highly head-marking. Verbal agreement marks the subject and the primary object (in the sense of Dryer 1986) if one exists. Possessed nominals display agreement with their possessors.
  - ∗ Transitive agreement morphemes are largely treated as portmanteaux indexing the features of both arguments. Intransitive agreement is "split-S," with an agent and a patient set of agreement morphemes.
- ✧ **Robust *pro*-drop.** Available for all verbal arguments as well as possessors.
- ✧ **Flexible word order.** All six orderings of subject, object, and verb attested in texts and accepted by speakers. Typically analyzed as being discourse-configurational (Mithun 2020; Flaim 2025).

- All uncited data comes from my elicitation work in Montréal and Ahkwesáhsne with my L1 collaborator Mary Onwá:ri Tekahawáhkwen McDonald, with a few additional judgments from Maureen Benedict, Hilda King, and Lyle Lazore. Unmarked examples are in the Ahkwesáhsne dialect, while cited examples marked with K. represent the Kahnawà:ke dialect.

3 Finding Condition C in Kanien'kéha

- Baker (1996) suggests that Condition C effects exist in Kanien'kéha based on an asymmetry between adjunct and complement clauses (replicated by the author).

- *Pro*-dropped pronouns (evidenced by verbal agreement) in matrix clauses may corefer with R-expressions in sentence-level adjunct clauses.[2]

(3) a. *Wa'ewennahnó:ton ohén:ton ne Katerí: aonsaionhtén:ti.*
pro_i wa'-ie-wennahnoton ohenton ne Kateri_i aonsa-ion-ahtenti
FACT-FIA-read[PUNC] before NE Catherine OPT.REP-FIA-go[PUNC]
'She_i read it before Catherine_i left.' (SUBJ *pro* = adjunct R-exp.)

b. *Ia'kheiatewenná:ta'ahse' ohén:ton ne onkiá'tshi*
ia'-khei-atewennata'-a-hs-e' pro_i ohenton ne onki-a'tshi_i
TRANS.FACT-1SG>FI-call-JR-BEN-PUNC before NE 1DUP-female.friend
akhenatarhé:na'se'.
a-khe-natarhena-'s-e'
OPT-1SG>FI-visit-BEN-PUNC
'I called her_i before I visited my friend_i.' (OBJ *pro* = adjunct R-exp.)

- Conversely, *pros* in matrix clauses may *not* corefer with R-expressions in complement clauses.

(4) a. *Wa'è:ron tsi Sosén: teiekahrí:ios.*
$pro_{*i/j}$ wa'-ie-ihron tsi Sosen_i te-ie-kahr-iio-s
FACT-FIA-say.PUNC C Susan DUP-FIA-eye-good-HAB
'$\text{She}_{*i/j}$ said that Susan_i has nice eyes.' (SUBJ *pro* ≠ CP R-exp.)

[2] I follow Leipzig conventions with the following additions and alterations: CIS = cislocative, C = complementizer, DUP = duplicative, FACT = factual, FI = feminine-indefinite, JR = joiner, NSF = noun suffix, OPT = optative, PUNC = punctual, Q = polar question particle, REP = repetitive, TRANS = translocative. Agreement morphemes are glossed as follows: transitive agreement portmanteaux are represented as X(NUM)>Y(NUM), where X and Y represent the person/gender features of the higher and lower arguments, respectively. Third persons are not glossed with a 3, but instead with their gender feature (as gender is not distinguished for local persons). Number is included for each argument if a number distinction is made for that person and gender specification. Intransitive agreement morphemes are glossed X(NUM)A or X(NUM)P, where X stands for the person features of the argument, and A or P represents agent set or patient set. Again, number is only marked if a distinction is made for a certain person/gender combination. I gloss "possessor set" agreement as patient agreement; see Boles (2024) for arguments.

b. *Wahiri'wanón:tonhse'* *ónhka Tié:r wahshakonatarhé:na'se'.*
wa-hi-ri'wanonton-hs-e' $pro_{*i/j}$ onhka Tier$_i$ wa-hshako-natarhena-'s-e'
FACT-1SG>MSG-ask-BEN-PUNC who Peter FACT-MSG>FI-visit-BEN-PUNC
'I asked him$_{*i/j}$ who Peter$_i$ visited.' (OBJ *pro* ≠ CP R-exp.)

- This asymmetry directly follows from standard definitions of binding (e.g., Chomsky 1981; Reinhart 1976, 1983).
  - Adjuncts adjoined to the sentence level are attached too high for matrix *pros* to bind into, meaning the adjunct-internal R-expression is free. → No Condition C violation; coreference allowed.
  - All matrix arguments c-command complement clauses, thus matrix *pros* can bind into them. → Condition C violation; no coreference allowed.

Condition C is relevant for coreference in Kanien'kéha.

- Kanien'kéha shows more expected Condition C behavior, assuming the subject asymmetrically c-commands the object: *pro* objects can corefer with R-expression possessors of subjects.

(5) *Warisó:se akotshé:na* *è:rhar wahshakoká:ri'.*
Warisose$_i$ ako-itshena ehrhar wa-hshako-kari-' pro_i
Josephine FIP-domesticated.animal dog FACT-MSG>FI-bite-PUNC
'Josephine$_i$'s dog bit her$_i$.'

- **Potential issue:** It appears that subject *pros* can corefer with R-expression possessors of objects—that is, it seems (6) is actually parsed as in (7).

(6) *RBChne thá:iens* (*ne*) *Wíshe raohwísta'.*
RBC-hne t-ha-ien-s (ne Wishe rao-hwist-a'
RBC-LOC CIS-MSGA-lay-HAB (NE Wishe MSGP-money-NSF
'Wíshe$_i$ keeps his$_i$ money at RBC.' (According to Baker: 'He$_i$ keeps Wíshe$_i$'s money at RBC.')

(7) *RBChne* [pro$_i$]$_{\text{SUBJ}}$ *thá:iens* [(*ne*) *Wíshe*$_i$ *raohwísta'*]$_{\text{OBJ}}$

- The parse in (7) should be ruled out by Condition C if the subject c-commands the object (as is crosslinguistically standard) in Kanien'kéha. Instead, objects appear able to occur outside of the c-command domain of subject *pros*.

  ⇒ Baker (1996) takes this as evidence that Kanien'kéha does not have standard argument structure.

Baker's more specific proposal

- All argument positions are filled by *pros*.
- Overt nominals are high-adjoined to the sentence, licensed by the *pros* in argument position.
- This follows from his Morphological Visibility Condition (the Polysynthesis Parameter): "A phrase X is visible for θ-role assignment from a head Y only if it is coindexed with a morpheme in the word containing Y via: (i) an agreement relationship, or (ii) a movement relationship." (Baker 1996:17).
- Details (not necessary for this poster): the MVC requires agreement morphology in the verbal word to assign θ-roles. Agreement morphemes adjoined to a head X receive the Case assigned by

X. This means that Case is never available for overt nominals, so they cannot appear in argument position without violating the Case Filter (Chomsky 1980).

- In being high adjuncts, overt nominals are always adjoined higher than the *pros* that occupy argument position. → Overt nominals can always escape c-command by a coreferent *pro*, ergo **no Condition C effects** for overt nominals.[3]
  - This proposal effectively means overt nominals have the same status as adjunct clauses. As shown, adjunct clauses don't show Condition C effects, therefore it's not surprising that overt nominals don't either.
- Condition C effects appear in complement clauses because these must be in argument position. They cannot be licensed by a *pro* because they do not share the same category features as *pros*.

Baker's bottom line: The universality of Condition C can be saved but only if languages fundamentally differ in a large way.

- Nevertheless, the Condition C data only supports such a radical split from standard argument structure proposals if the parse in (7) is the correct one. That is, this only follows *if the R-expression is truly within the object constituent...*

4 A structural ambiguity analysis

- Given the adjunct-complement clause asymmetry, I follow Baker (1996) in suggesting that Kanien'kéha does exhibit Condition C effects.
- However, I propose a different analysis for apparent Condition C violations in the language.

My proposal

Structural ambiguity is the culprit behind apparent Condition C violations in Kanien'kéha. This structural ambiguity arises as a by-product of *flexible word order* and *robust* pro-*drop*.

- Multiple acceptable orderings of overt nominals as well as the widespread use of phonologically null pronouns often leads to strings that are parsable in multiple ways.
- These strings are often ambiguous between a parse that obeys Condition C and one that violates it, creating the illusion of accepted Condition C violations.
- Explicitly, I propose (8) is ambiguous, with both a Condition C-violating parse (9a), which Baker adopts, and a Condition C-abiding parse (9b).

[3] However, Baker later claims that overt nominals in Kanien'kéha are clitic left-dislocated. He shows that, as expected of CLLD nominals in, e.g., Romance, overt nominals must reconstruct into argument position in certain cases. This should mean that overt nominals should also reconstruct for Condition C, falsely predicting Condition C to hold in examples like (6). He suggests that the reason this does not happen is that possessed nominals in Kanien'kéha are relative clauses, since material inside of relative clauses does not reconstruct for binding purposes (e.g., Lebeaux 1989). Nevertheless, the argument is not strong, with the only good evidence for this claim being the Condition C data itself and the behavior of other languages that obey the MVC.

(8) *RBChne thá:iens* (*ne*) *Wíshe raohwísta'*.
RBC-hne t-ha-ien-s (ne Wishe rao-hwist-a'
RBC-LOC CIS-MSGA-lay-HAB (NE Wishe MSGP-money-NSF
'Wíshe$_i$ keeps his$_i$ money at RBC.' (According to Baker: 'He$_i$ keeps Wíshe$_i$'s money at RBC.')

(9) a. *Violating parse (Baker's)*
RBChne [pro$_i$]$_{\text{SUBJ}}$ *thá:iens* [(*ne*) *Wíshe$_i$ raohwísta'*]$_{\text{OBJ}}$

b. *Non-violating parse*
RBChne thá:iens [(*ne*) *Wíshe$_i$*]$_{\text{SUBJ}}$ [pro$_i$ *raohwísta'*]$_{\text{OBJ}}$.

- Speakers accept coreference with the second parse in mind, that is, that Kanien'kéha obeys Condition C as expected of standard argument structure proposals.
- Structural ambiguity can "bleed" Condition C effects in this way because **ambiguous strings are always parsable in a Condition C-abiding way**.

  ⇒ Speakers will always accept coreference readings for these strings when asked in elicitation.
- A few repercussions:

  ❶ Condition C remains universal: violations can be chalked up to surface properties.

  ❷ Another crosslinguistic "tool" to "bleed" Condition C.

  ❸ The Condition C data is **not** evidence for deviant argument structure proposals, contra Baker (1996).

  ❹ Condition C cannot always be reliably tested with simple sentences (see also Legate 2002; Royer 2025).

4.1 Evidence from conjoined objects

- The structural ambiguity analysis makes a **strong prediction**: in cases where structural ambiguity with respect to R-expressions does **not** arise, Condition C effects should operate as expected of standard argument structure in which the subject asymmetrically c-commands the object.
- I show that this is the case with novel data from conjoined possessed objects.
- **Possessors may both precede or follow their possessa** in both elicitation and natural contexts, though there is a strong preference for possessors preceding possessa in both cases.

(10) *Wahiientéhrha'ne' ne* {*Warisó:se akóhskare.* / *akóhskare Warisó:se.*}
wa-hi-ientehrha'n-e' ne {Warisose ako-hskar-e' ako-hskar-e' Warisose
FACT-1SG>MSG-meet-PUNC NE {Josephine FIP-partner-NSF FIP-partner-NSF Josephine
'I met Josephine's boyfriend.'

- Turning to conjoined objects, there is an **asymmetry of allowed coreference** between a subject and an (apparent) R-expression possessor of an object conjunct **based on ordering** of the putative possessor and its possessa.
- Coreference between a subject and a possessor of a conjunct is **disallowed** when the possessor appears either *after the first conjunct or before the second conjunct*.

(11) a. *Wahó:ti* *ne raonhotónkwa Kó:r tánon' raò:sere.*
$pro_{*i/j}$ wa-ho-ati ne rao-nhotonkwa **Kor**$_i$ tanon' $pro_?$ rao-'sere
FACT-MsgP-lose[PUNC] NE MsgP-key Paul and MsgP-car
'He$_{*i/j}$ lost Paul$_i$'s keys and his$_?$ car.'

b. *Wahó:ti* *ne raonhotónkwa tánon' Kó:r raò:sere.*
$pro_{*i/j}$ wa-ho-ati ne $pro_{*i/j}$ rao-nhotonkwa tanon' **Kor**$_i$ rao-'sere
FACT-MsgP-lose[PUNC] NE MsgP-key and Paul MsgP-car
'He$_{*i/j}$ lost his$_{*i/j}$ keys and Paul$_i$'s car.' (SUBJ ≠ OBJ poss'r)

- On the other hand, coreference is **allowed** when the possessor appears *before the first conjunct and after the second conjunct*.

(12) a. *Wahó:ti* *ne Kó:r raonhotónkwa tánon' raò:sere.*
pro_i wa-ho-ati ne **Kor**$_i$ rao-nhotonkwa tanon' pro_i rao-'sere
-MsgP-lose[PUNC] NE Paul MsgP-key and MsgP-car
'Paul$_i$ lost his$_i$ keys and his$_i$ car.'

b. *Wahó:ti* *ne raonhotónkwa tánon' raò:sere Kó:r.*
pro_i wa-ho-ati ne pro_i rao-nhotonkwa tanon' rao-'sere **Kor**$_i$
FACT-MsgP-lose[PUNC] NE MsgP-key and MsgP-car Paul
'Paul$_i$ lost his$_i$ keys and his$_i$ car.' (SUBJ = OBJ poss'r)

- The pattern is that if the R-expression is on the "inside" edges of the conjoined possessed objects, coreference does not obtain, while when the R-expression is on the "outside" edges of the conjoined possessed objects, coreference is accessible.

(13) a. V NP$_{\text{OBJ}}$ {R-exp} *tánon'* {R-exp} NP$_{\text{OBJ}}$ → ✗ Subject and possessor of object coreference
b. V {R-exp} NP$_{\text{OBJ}}$ *tánon'* NP$_{\text{OBJ}}$ {R-exp} → ✓ Subject and possessor of object coreference

- Under Baker's analysis:
  - The R-expression in both (11) and (12) is a possessor internal to the object constituent, regardless of ordering.
  - Overt nominals are always sentence-level adjuncts, so the R-expression always escapes c-command by subject *pro* whether it is position before or after one of the possessa.
  - The prediction under this accounts is that all of these examples should exhibit no Condition C effects. He has **no account for the obligatory disjoint reference in examples like (11)**.
- The conjoined possessed object data is evidence for the structural ambiguity analysis!

The first case (11) = (13a): The string is *not* structurally ambiguous vis-à-vis the identity of the R-expression.

- The conjoined objects must be parsed together.
- Attempts to parse the R-expression as anything other than a possessor fail because Kanien'kéha observes the Coordinate Structure Constraint (Boles 2024).
- The only licit parse forces a *pro* subject, which c-commands the R-expression. ⇒ **Condition C violation! No coreference!**

(14) V [$pro_{*i/j}$]$_{\text{SUBJ}}$ [NP {R-exp$_i$} *tánon'* {R-exp$_i$} NP]$_{\text{OBJ}}$

The second case (12) = (13b): The string *is* structurally ambiguous as to the identity of the R-expression

- It is entirely possible to parse the R-expression as a possessor of one of the objects, which would lead to a Condition C violation and achieving a disjoint reading.

(15) V [$pro_{*i/j}$]$_{\text{SUBJ}}$ [{R-exp$_i$} NP *tánon'* NP {R-exp$_i$}]$_{\text{OBJ}}$

- However, these examples also exhibit a parse in which the R-expression is parsed separately from the conjoined objects. **This parse does not violate Condition C**: the R-expression subject is not bound. This allows for coreferent readings!

  ➢ This is the parse speakers use when allowing coreference in these sentences.

(16) V {[R-exp$_i$]$_{\text{SUBJ}}$} [pro_i NP *tánon'* pro_i NP]$_{\text{OBJ}}$ {[R-exp$_i$]$_{\text{SUBJ}}$}

- **The existence of a parse for (12) = (13b) that does not violate Condition C renders Condition C effects irrelevant.**
  - The apparent violation is accepted by speakers because they simply **reparse** it in a Condition C-abiding way.
- The availability of several parses for these sentences is a direct function of Kanien'kéha's flexible word order and robust *pro*-drop.

> As predicted, when the location of the R-expression is not ambiguous, **Kanien'kéha shows standard Condition C behavior.**

4.2 Some important results

- **A cautionary tale:** In some languages, strings can be ambiguous as to whether they violate Condition C or not—all based on the parse.

  ⇒ Important to test Condition with more than just basic configurations: more complex configurations (e.g., conjoined possessed objects, relative clauses, adverbials) often offer less structural ambiguity and hence more reliable behavior. (See also Legate 2002; Royer 2025 for variations on this same point.)

- **Condition C universality:** Kanien'kéha appears to allow Condition C violations. ⇒ This is an accident of parsing, due to the superficial properties of flexible word order and *pro*-drop. Importantly, when ambiguity does not arise, Condition C is respected.

  ⇒ Condition C remains a universal. Structural ambiguity is another way that languages can "bleed" Condition C crosslinguistically.

- **Argument structure:** The conjoined possessed object data only follow if the subject asymmetrically c-commands the object. Otherwise, it is unclear why trapping the R-expression inside the object results in no coreference with the subject, while parsing the R-expression as a subject restores the coreference.

  ⇒ The Condition C data are not evidence for abandonment of crosslinguistically standard argument structure approaches; instead, they argue *for* them.

In short, structural ambiguity (due to surface properties) allows apparent violations of Condition C without requiring languages to differ at a fundamental level.

5 Against Baker's (1996) tests

- Baker (1996) goes through a sequence of tests to confirm that the R-expression in sentences like (6) is part of the object constituent.

  → That is, tests to show the parse I suggest is unavailable.

- **These tests are not sufficient** to rule out a parse like the one I suggest.

5.1 Polar questions

- Polar questions in Kanien'kéha involve a fronted constituent as well as the polar question particle *ken*.
- Baker (1996) shows that *ken* is a second position element, following the fronted constituent.
- Using this, he suggests that in sentences like (17), the R-expression *Onwari* must occupy an object-internal possessor position.

(17) *Onwá:ri akóhskare' ken wa'thonwanoronhkwánion'?*
Onwari$_i$ ako-hskar-e' ken *pro*$_i$ wa't-**honwa**-noronhkwanion-'
Onwari FIP-partner-NSF Q FACT.DUP-FI>MSG-kiss-PUNC
'Did she$_i$ kiss Onwá:ri$_i$'s boyfriend?' (Baker 1996:46, K.)

- Under the assumption that this is A'-movement of the object (DeCaire et al. 2017) and that A'-movement reconstructs for Condition C (Barss 1986; Chomsky 1995; Fox 1999), the R-expression should reconstruct under an subject *pro*, resulting in an expected violation.

Problem: Third-position *ken* is attested, specifically when there is a topicalized element and a focused element (Flaim 2025).

(18) *Katya só:ra ken én:ieke'?*
Katya sora ken en-ie-k-e'
Katya duck Q FUT-FIA-eat-PUNC
'As for Katya, will she eat the duck?'

- This means that (17) may involve a topicalized *Onwari*, which creates no problems for Condition C.
  - Unclear of what to make of data like this in Baker (1996), since there are no contexts or prosodic data.

5.2 Complex NPs

- Baker (1996) additionally suggests that subject *pros* can corefer with R-expressions in complex NP objects.
- This should be bad if the subject asymmetrically c-commands the object in Kanien'kéha: subject *pro* should bind into the complex NP and thus lead to a Condition C violation.

Problem: This test is not replicable; my collaborator and Baker's have different judgments.

(19)

Kaná:takon		*wa'(e)tshiseni:ken'*	*í:se'*	*tánon'*	*Sá:k*	*raóhskare'.*
ka-nat-a-kon	*pro*	wa'-(e)tshiseni-ken-'	ise'	tanon'	Sak	rao-hskar-e'
NA-town-JR-in.LOC		FACT-MSG>2DU-see-PUNC	2PRO	and	Sak	MSGP-partner-NSF

'He$_i$ saw you and Sá:k$_i$'s girlfriend in town.' (Baker's speakers' judgments)
'He$_{*i/j}$ saw you and Sá:k$_i$'s girlfriend in town.' (my collaborator's judgments)

5.3 Demonstrative-headed objects

- Baker (1996) suggests that the demonstratives *kiken* 'this' and *thiken* 'that' precede entire DP constituents.
  - He argues that R-expression possessors inside a *kiken*- or *thiken*-headed DP can corefer with the subject *pro*.

Problem: These judgements are difficult and not clear cut; my collaborator shows internal inconsistencies.

(20) a.

	Wa'e'níkhon'	*ne*	*thí:ken*	*Arísawe*	*ako'wháhsa'.*
pro$_{*i/j}$	wa'-ie-'nikhon-'	ne	thiken	Arisawe$_i$	ako-'whahs-a'
	-FIA-sew-	NE	that	Arisawe	FIP-skirt-

'She$_{*i/j}$ sewed that skirt of Arísawe$_i$'s.' (✗ coreference)

b.

	Wahará:ko'	*ne*	*thí:ken*	*Wíshe*	*raotó:ken.*
pro$_i$	wa'-ha-r-a-kw-'	ne	thiken	Wishe$_i$	rao-atoken
	-MSGA-put.in–REV-	NE	that	Wishe	MSGP-axe

'He$_i$ picked that axe of Wíshe$_i$'s.' (✓ coreference)

- **These tests do not rule out a parse like I suggest.**

6 Conclusion

- Kanien'kéha exhibits Condition C effects **across the board**.
- Structural ambiguity, caused by flexible word order and robust *pro*-drop, allows strings with both Condition C-obeying and Condition C-violating parses, with two important effects:
  (i) Condition C remains universal
  (ii) Contra Baker (1996), Kanien'kéha requires a **standard argument structure** configuration.

➢ In sum, the Condition C data allows us to maintain the universality of Condition C without requiring a deep, fundamental difference between Kanien'kéha and other languages.

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